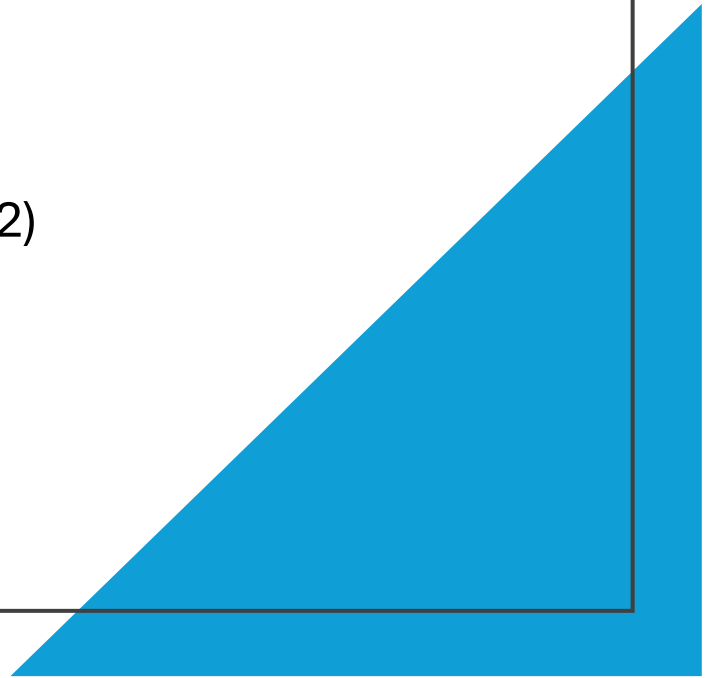


Kia & Hyundai Vehicle Theft Trends: A Public Safety Briefing

Evidence of a targeted and unevenly distributed theft surge (2019–2022)

- Jon Steen
- MSDS, Bellevue University
- DSC 640: Data Presentation and Visualization
- Instructor: Benjamin Schneider
- Feb 1, 2026



Why Focus on Kia and Hyundai Theft?



Vehicle thefts have increased nationally



Kia and Hyundai thefts show a distinct growth pattern

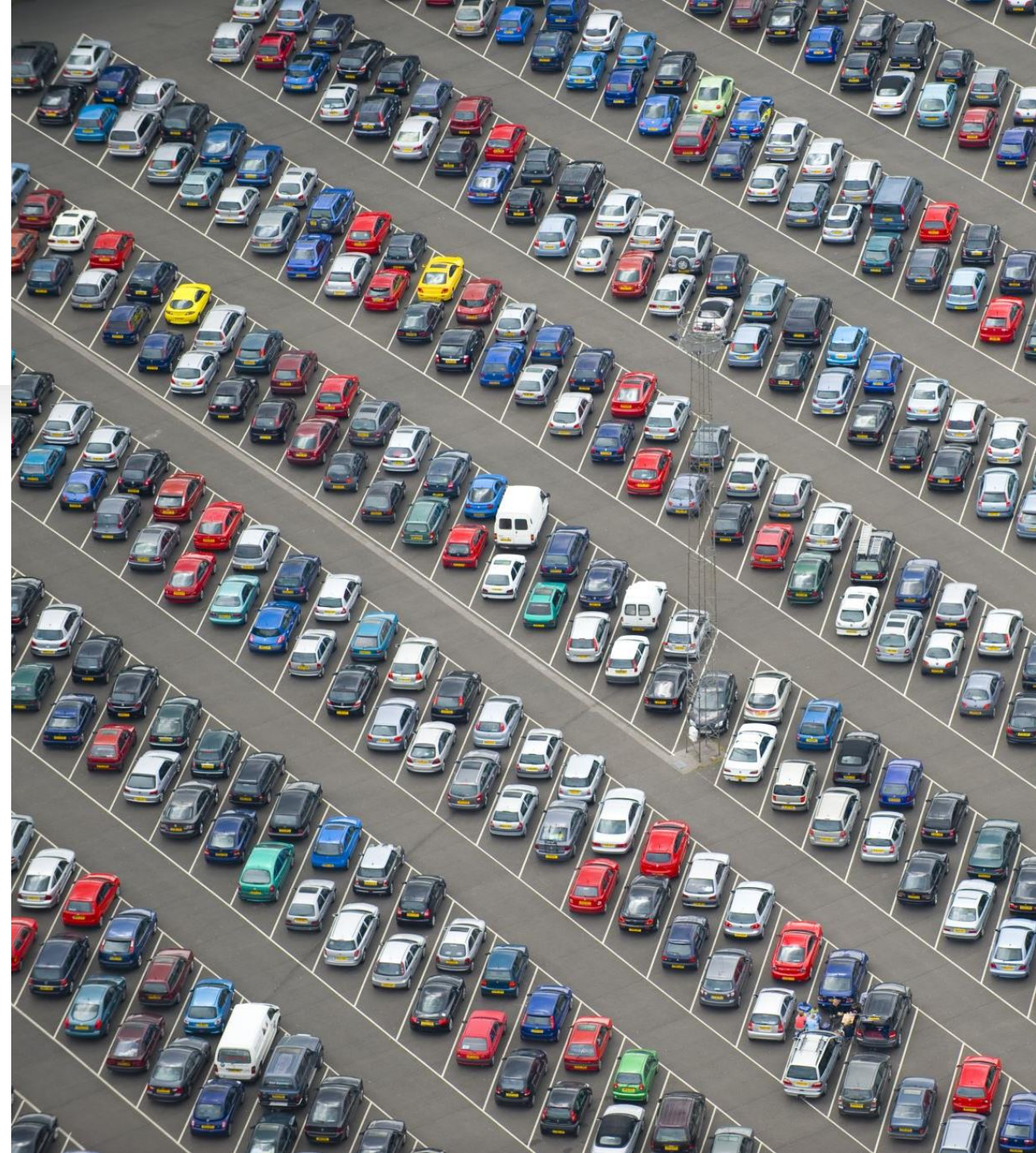


Impact is concentrated in specific cities



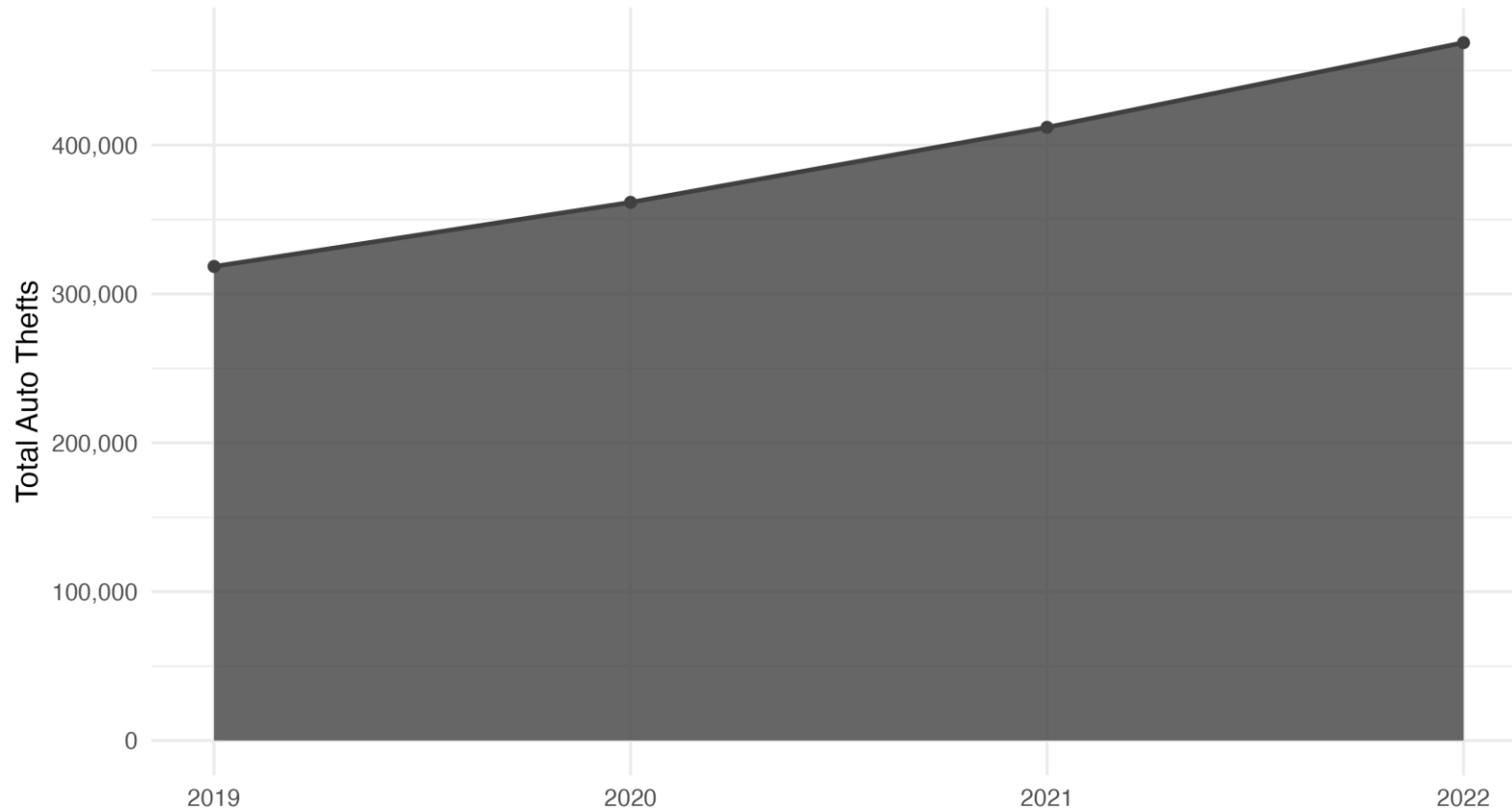
Briefing Context

- **Audience:** City officials and public safety leadership
- **Purpose:** Identify whether Kia/Hyundai thefts warrant targeted intervention
- **Call to Action:** Approve focused prevention measures in high-impact areas



Context: Overall Auto Thefts (2019–2022)

Total thefts across all tracked agencies (Background Trend)

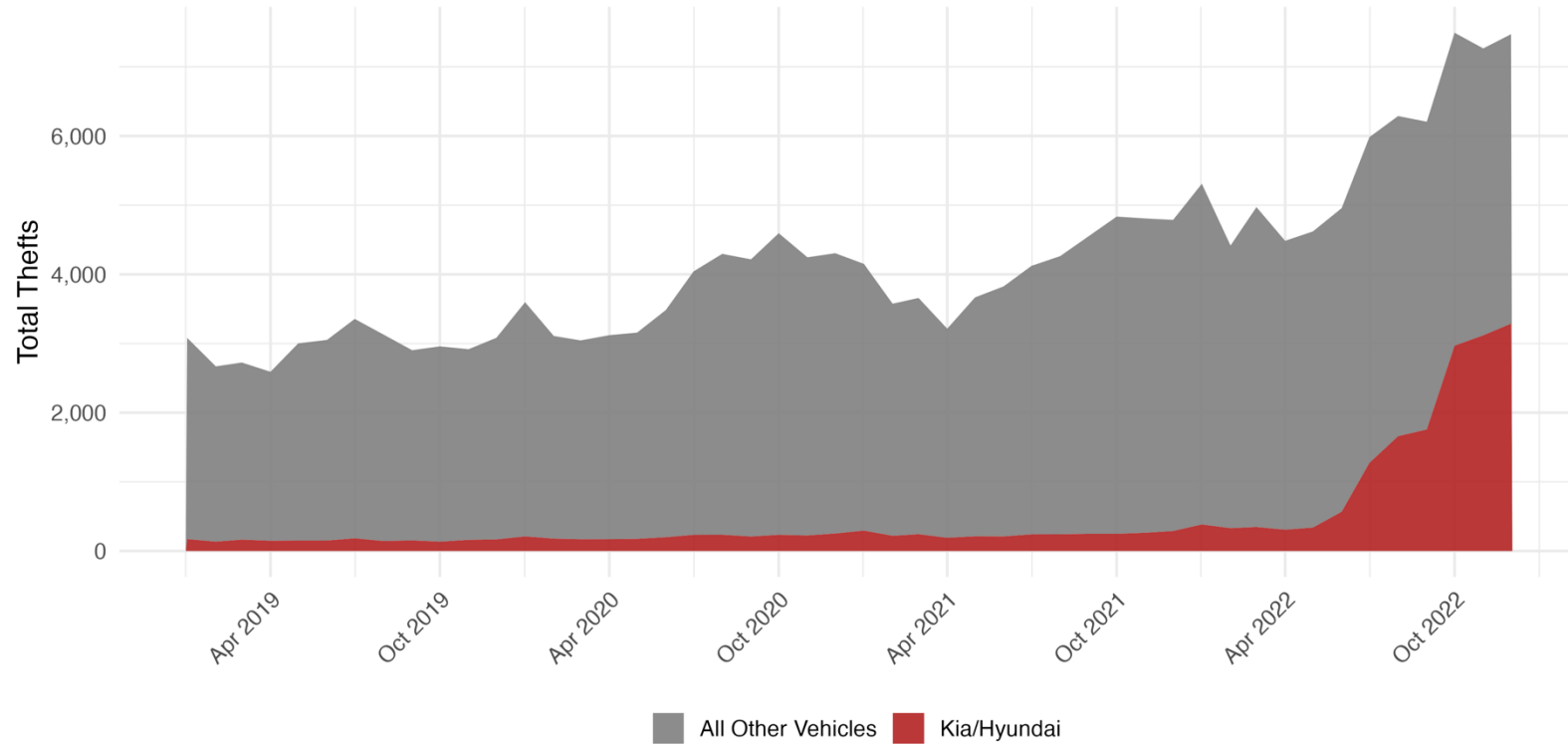


Auto thefts increased across agencies between 2019 and 2022.

Overall
Auto Thefts
Are Rising

Kia/Hyundai Theft Surge Over Time

Monthly totals across included cities

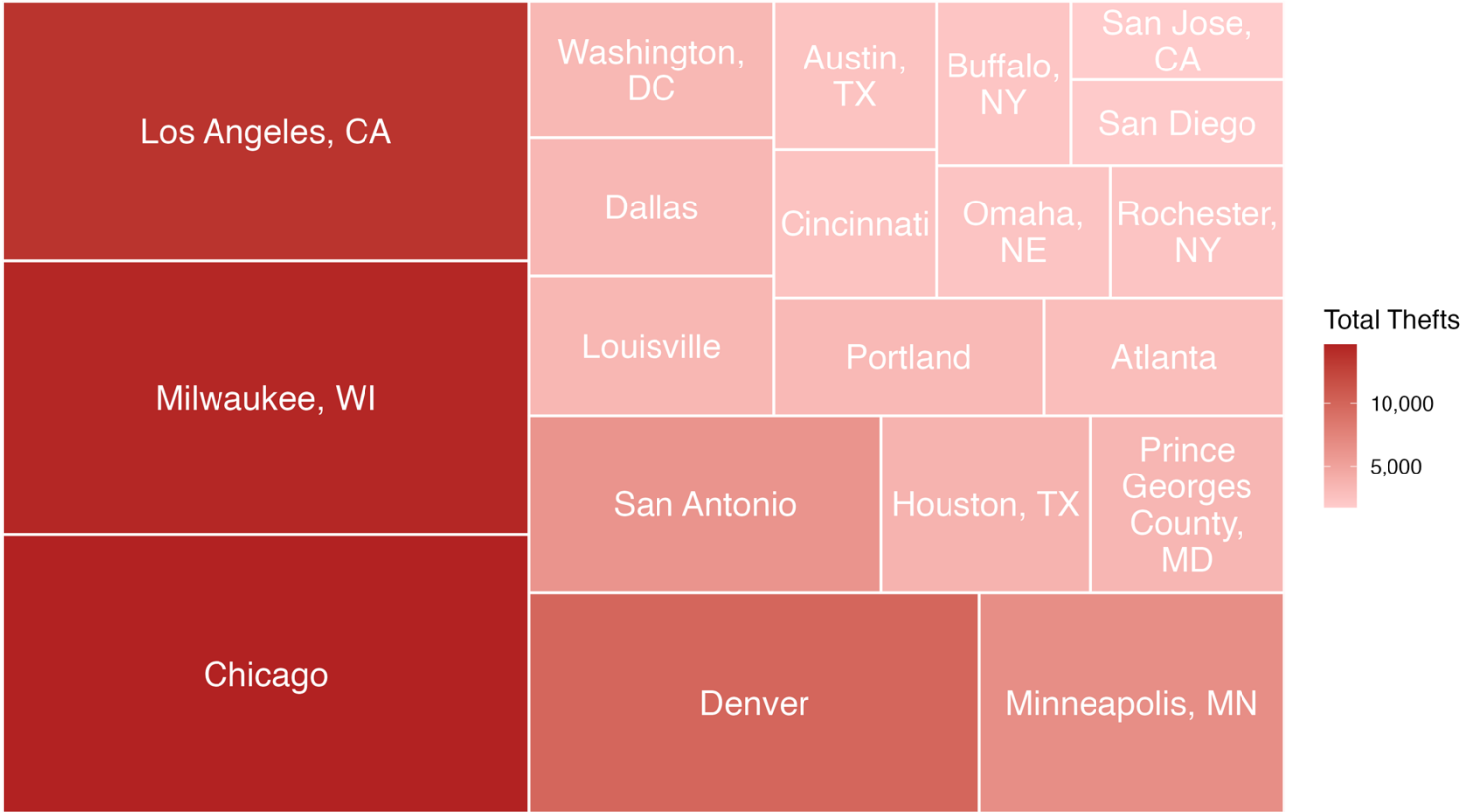


Kia and Hyundai thefts accelerate sharply beginning in mid-2022.

Kia and
Hyundai Theft
Growth
Exceeds
Baseline
Trends

Cities Most Impacted by Kia/Hyundai Thefts

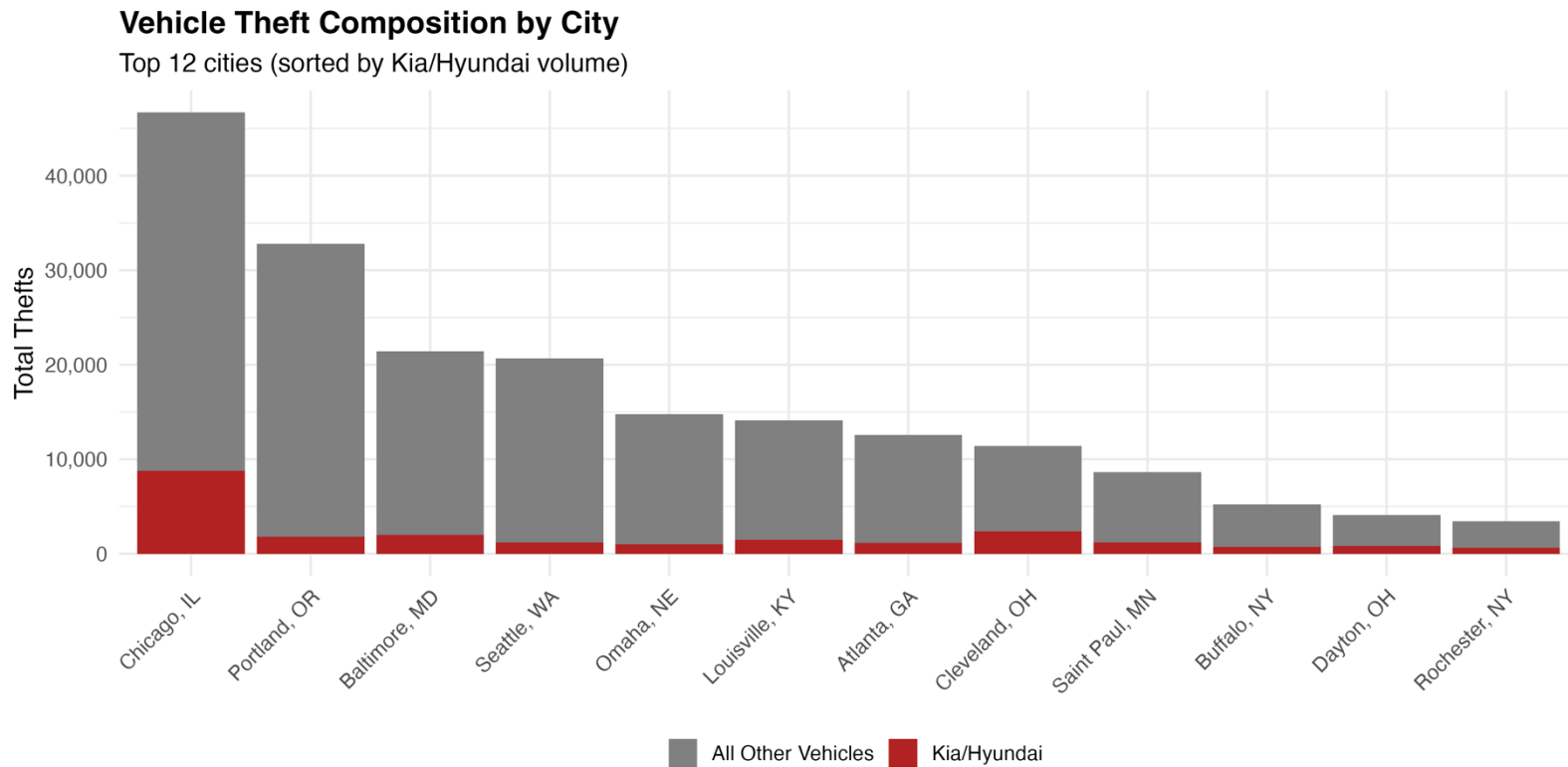
Aggregated counts (Top 20 Cities) from Vice News dataset



Source: Motherboard/Vice News

A limited number of cities account for a disproportionate share of incidents.

Impact Is
Concentrated,
Not Uniform

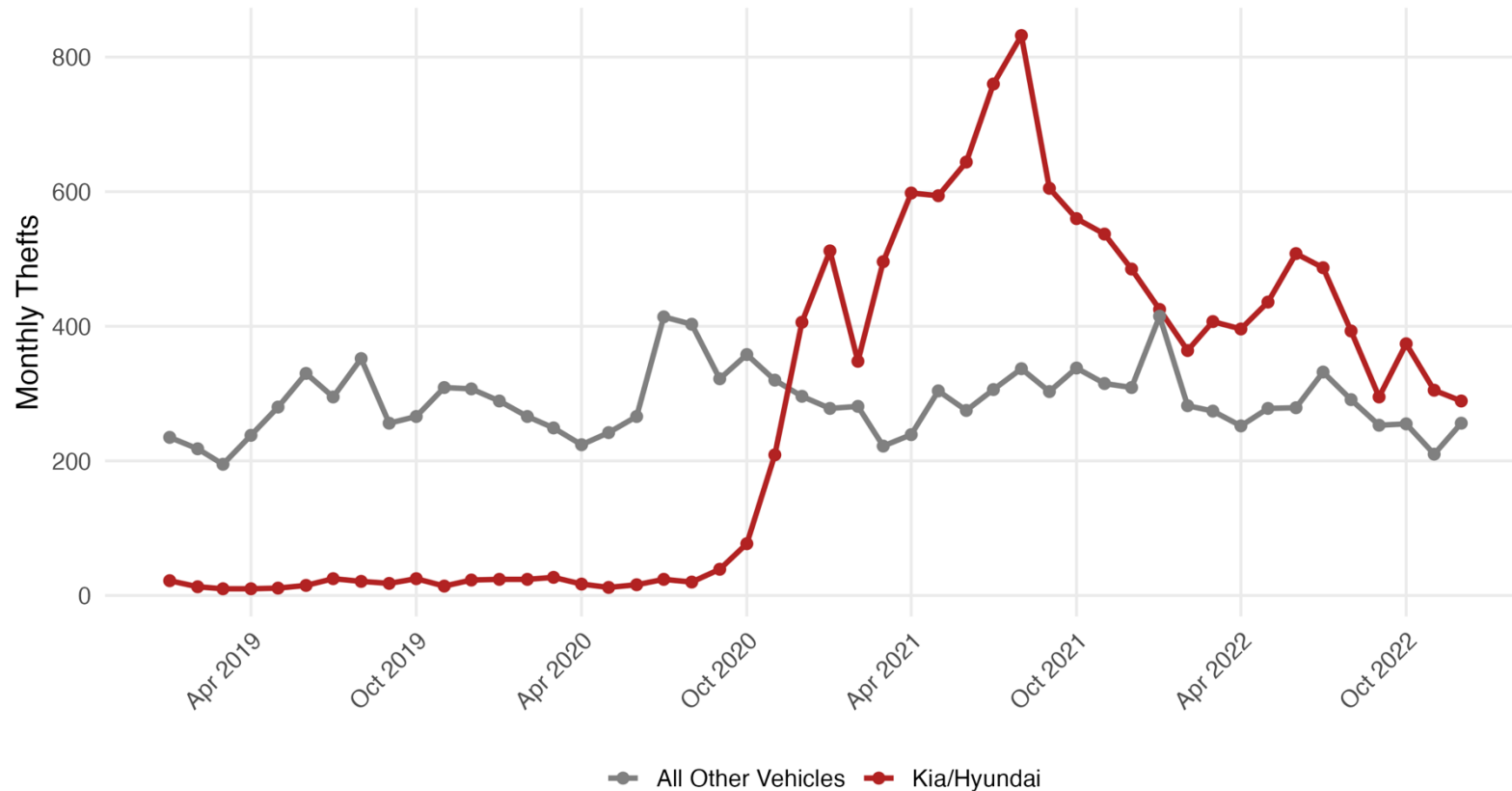


In several cities, Kia and Hyundai thefts make up a notably higher share of total thefts.

Kia/Hyundai Theft Share Varies by City

Milwaukee: The Kia/Hyundai 'Explosion'

Monthly theft counts: Kias vs. All Other Vehicles (2019–2022)

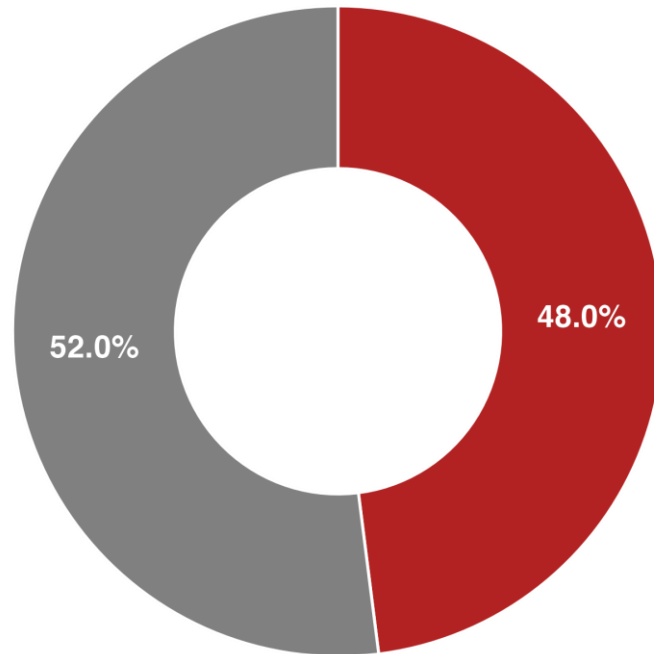


Kia/Hyundai thefts increased rapidly while other vehicle thefts remained stable.

Case Study: Milwaukee

Milwaukee Vehicle Thefts: Kia/Hyundai Share

Aggregated data (2019–2022)



■ All Other Vehicles ■ Kia/Hyundai

By the end of the period, Kia/Hyundai vehicles accounted for nearly half of reported thefts.

Milwaukee Theft Distribution

Policy Implications

- The issue is targeted and location-specific
- Broad, citywide responses may be inefficient
- Focused prevention aligns better with observed patterns



Recommended Actions

1

Expand steering-wheel lock distribution in high-risk areas

2

Adjust patrol allocation during peak theft periods

3

Deploy localized public awareness campaigns



Closing

Data supports targeted intervention over generalized response.